

New Authority Insurance Checklist

Everything you need to get your authority insured correctly, quoted fast, and protected from day one.

01 Core coverages to put in place

- ☐ **Primary / Auto Liability:** Required to activate your authority. FMCSA minimum is \$750K, but most brokers and shippers require \$1M CSL to give you loads.
- ☐ **Motor Truck Cargo:** Covers the freight you haul. \$100K is common; match the limit to the value of loads you actually book, and check reefer breakdown terms.
- ☐ **Physical Damage:** Comprehensive & collision on your tractor and trailer. Usually required if the equipment is financed.
- ☐ **Trailer Interchange:** If you pull trailers you don't own under an interchange agreement.
- ☐ **Non-Trucking Liability / Bobtail:** For driving without a load or off dispatch, especially if leased to a carrier.
- ☐ **Driver injury coverage:** Workers' compensation or occupational accident for you and any drivers.

02 What drives your first-year pricing

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|---|---|
| ☐ Time in business (new-authority surcharge applies) | ☐ Equipment year, type, and value |
| ☐ CDL experience, age, and motor vehicle record | ☐ Garaging location / home state |
| ☐ Radius of operation and commodities hauled | ☐ Down payment and payment history |

Reality check: A clean MVR and realistic radius/commodity info are the two things most within your control that move your premium. Be accurate, not optimistic.

03 Documents to have ready for a fast quote

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|---|---|
| ☐ MC / DOT number and EIN | ☐ Commodities, radius, and estimated miles |
| ☐ Driver list: names, DOBs, CDLs, MVRs | ☐ Prior insurance and loss runs (if any) |
| ☐ Equipment list: VIN, year, make, value | ☐ Desired liability and cargo limits |

04 Common mistakes new authorities make

- ☐ Underinsuring cargo for the loads they actually haul, then eating the difference on a claim.
- ☐ Buying only the FMCSA minimum liability, then losing loads because brokers require \$1M.
- ☐ Misstating radius or commodities, which can lead to denied claims later.
- ☐ Letting coverage lapse, which creates filing gaps against your authority.
- ☐ Never re-shopping after the first year, when seasoning should lower the rate.

Pro move: Ask your agent to re-market your policy at your first renewal. Once you have 12 clean months, you are a very different risk than the day you filed.

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